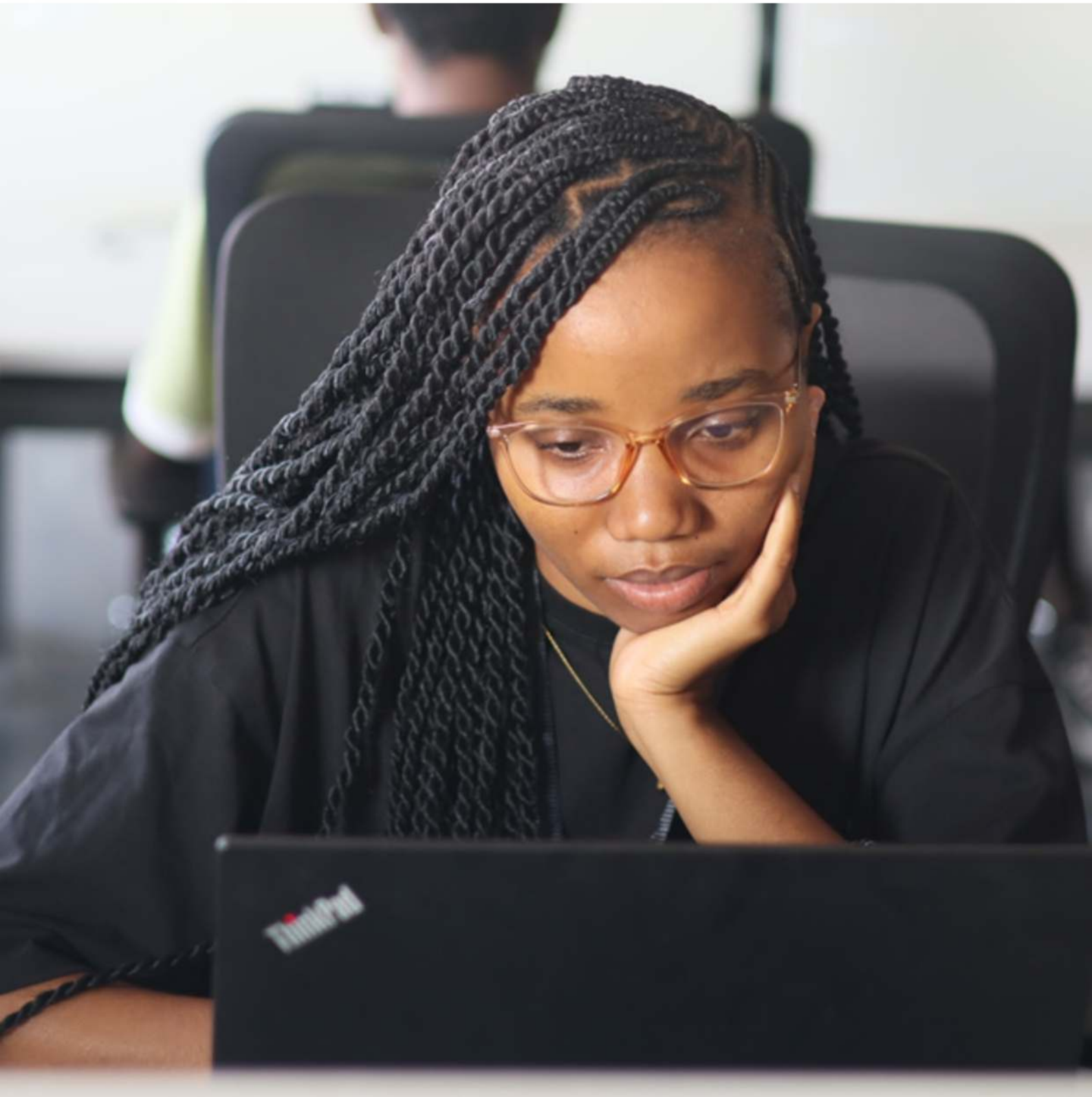
LakeHub
TECHIES & CREATIVES

Zone 01
Kisumu

QUARTER 1 IMPACT REPORT

January, February and March 2026



ABOUT LAKEHUB



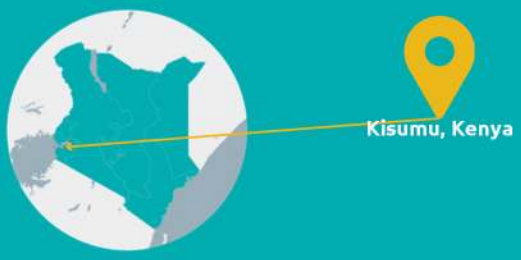
Vision

Lakehub was founded with the belief that investing in tech education and development of Africa's youth is essential for the growth and progress of the continent, and it is committed to providing the resources and support that these young people need to reach their full potential.

Through Zone01 Kisumu, we provide youths from all backgrounds with an opportunity to learn software development from scratch through peer-to-peer activities after which, they are guaranteed employment.

Mission

Our mission is to **decentralize access to technology tools and resources**, making them readily available to young people in underserved areas. By providing comprehensive tech education, mentorship programs, and access to cutting-edge technology, we equip young individuals with the skills and resources necessary to succeed in a digital economy



NOTE FROM THE CO-EXECUTIVE DIRECTORS

Ladies and Gentlemen,

In April 2024, after interviewing 420 candidates out of 15,000 plus applications, we opened our doors to 96 young Kenyans from diverse backgrounds and undeserving communities who had a passion for software development.

Their stories were quite compelling; they had finished high school but their families had no resources to support their further education, others had joined colleges and universities and had dropped out for lack of fees, and there were those who had graduated from institutions of higher learning but faced the harsh reality of the astonishingly high levels of youth unemployment in Kenya. But all this changed when they heard about LakeHub's Zone01 Kisumu program.

Zone01 made a simple promise; we will train you intensively over a period of 2 years to be a world-class software developer and give you well-paying jobs. Not only that, Zone01 and their partners also committed to give them study stipends during the entirety of their training period to cushion them from several immediate economic pressures allowing them to concentrate on their skill development. These young men and women believed in this mission to 'Recode the World with Africa's Talent'.

What a journey it has been! Be it here in Kenya's capital Nairobi, Cape Town in South Africa, Kigali in Rwanda, Kampala in Uganda, Addis Ababa in Ethiopia, Antananarivo in Madagascar, Munich in Germany or Singapore, our talents have graced world capitals displaying impeccable software skills and expertise in Artificial Intelligence and Emerging Technologies, Robotics, Mobile and Web App Development, Blockchain, Cybersecurity and Devops, Video Games and Data Engineering.

24 months later, now in April 2026, we are happy and deeply proud to be graduating this Cohort. 70 of them have landed jobs even before program completion which translates to an impressive 73% job placement rate. Their average income is USD 589 (KES 76,071) with the highest grossing USD 2,500 (KES 322,500). Juxtaposed against the study stipends as their initial income, the percentage increase in income is 407.14%. For the highest earners, it is 2050%! This truly shows the remarkable impact this program has had over these young people, and we are sure that they will live to be the backbone of Kenya and the region's IT sector.

We therefore invite you to join us on Friday, 10th April, 2026 at the Acacia Premier Hotel in Kisumu City at our inaugural "Build From Here' Tech Conference to celebrate our developers on this milestone achievement and align with the tech industry regarding our mission.

We also extend our deepest appreciation to all our partners who have supported us in this journey most notably the County Government of Kisumu, Partners for Equity, 01Talent, Livelihood Impact Fund, UNDP, Segal Family Foundation and the World Bank (KIEP SKIES program).

Nelson Mandela was definitely right when he said that 'education is the most powerful weapon which you can use to change the world'.

Sincerely,

Dorcas Owino &
Caleb Nyoiro

CO-EXECUTIVE DIRECTORS

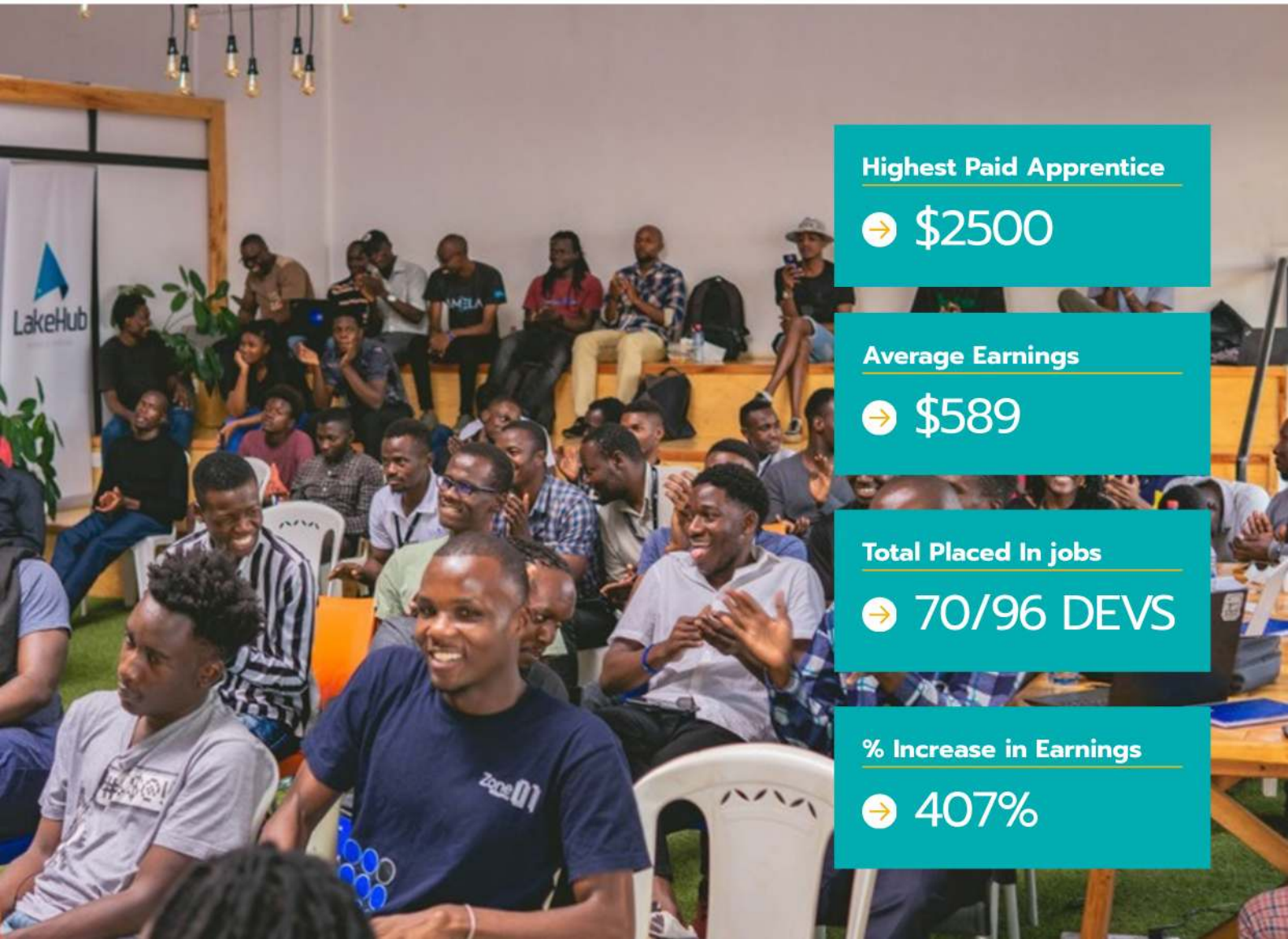
73% OF COHORT 1 APPRENTICES PLACED IN JOBS

The success of Zone01 Kisumu's first cohort demonstrates the effectiveness of our learning model in preparing talent for a rapidly evolving technology industry. By the end of Q1 2026, **70 out of 96 apprentices** from Cohort 1 had secured paid employment, a significant milestone for a programme designed to equip learners with industry-ready skills.

Prior to joining the programme, most of these young people had little or no formal income. Today, **their average monthly earnings have risen from nothing to an average of KSh 76,071**, reflecting both the quality of their training and the strong demand for their skills in the digital economy. Notably, **the highest-earning apprentice from the cohort is now earning KSh 322,500 per month**, demonstrating the remarkable upward mobility that access to high-quality technical education can unlock.

This achievement is particularly significant at a time when the global software industry is undergoing rapid transformation due to advances in artificial intelligence. Undeniably, Artificial Intelligence is reshaping how software is built, yet the success of our Cohort 1 affirms that the peer-to-peer, project-based pedagogy remains highly relevant.

By focusing on problem-solving, collaboration, real-world project development and battery of soft skills rather than rote instruction, we equip our apprentices with adaptable skills (including AI tools) that extend beyond simple code generation. These are the skills that employers are increasingly seeking. **The strong employment outcomes of this cohort show that our model not only prepares learners for today's opportunities but also positions them to thrive in the future of AI-augmented software development.**



Highest Paid Apprentice

$2500

Average Earnings

$589

Total Placed In jobs

70/96 DEVS

% Increase in Earnings

407%

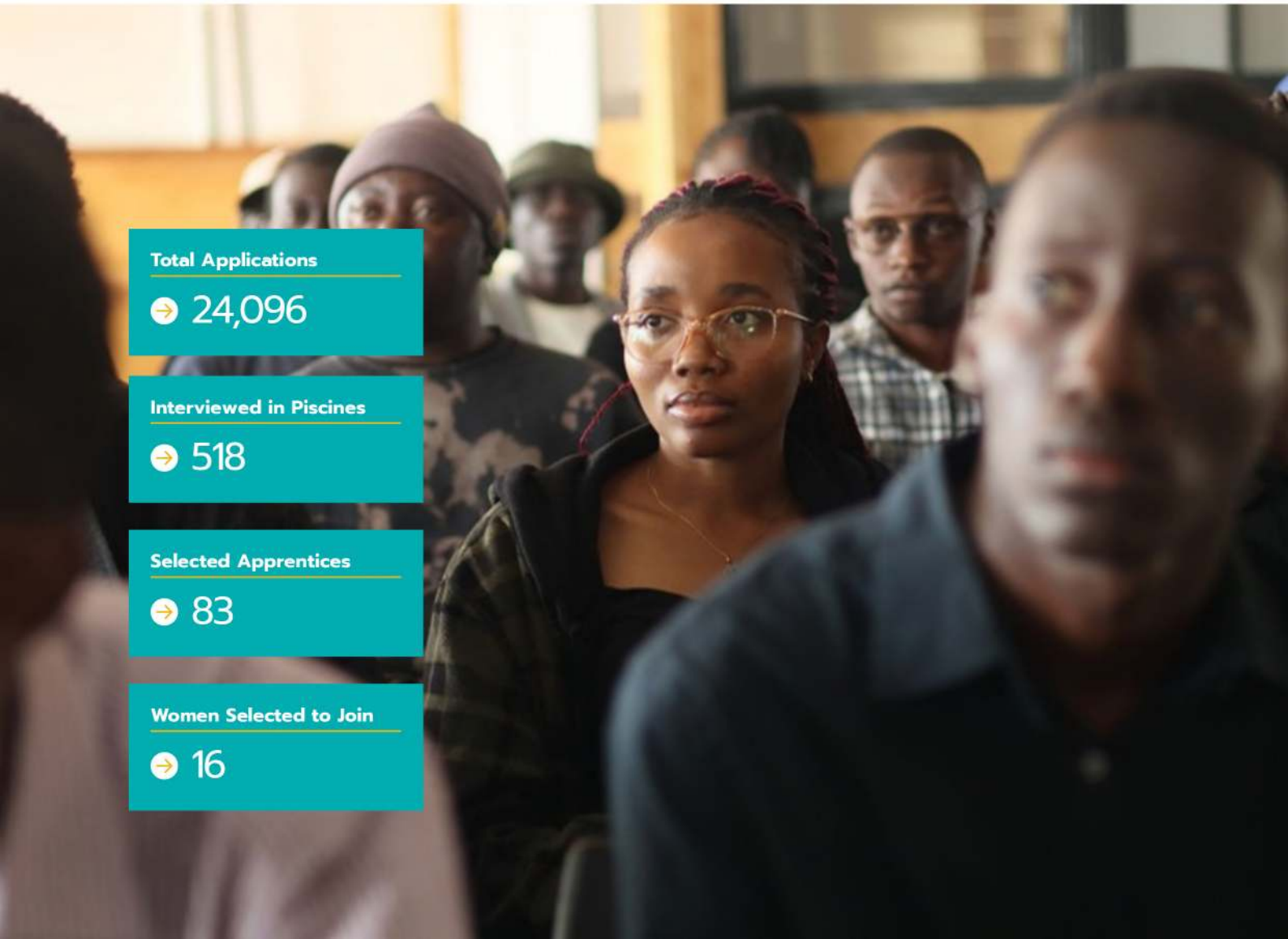
NEWLY SELECTED COHORT 2 APPRENTICES SETTLE IN

Recruitment for Zone01 Kisumu's second cohort has demonstrated both the demand for high-quality, accessible technology training and the strong reputation the programme is building in East Africa. So far, we received over 24,096 applications, reflecting significant interest from young people not just in Kenya, but from Uganda, seeking pathways into the digital economy.

Through our rigorous selection process, **we have so far shortlisted 518 candidates for interviews (Piscines) in Quarter 1 2026**. These selection piscines emphasised technical up skilling, problem-solving ability as well as collaboration amongst the candidates.

From this highly competitive pool, **83 apprentices have been selected to join Cohort 2**. This careful selection ensures that the cohort brings together individuals with strong potential to thrive in Zone01 Kisumu's peer-to-peer, project-based learning environment. The scale and competitiveness of the recruitment process highlights both the need and the opportunity for initiatives that democratise access to technology careers.

Applicants joining Zone01 Kisumu come from diverse educational and socio-economic backgrounds, underscoring our role in opening doors to women and youth who might otherwise lack access to high-quality tech training. We continue to build a pipeline of talented developers prepared to contribute to the digital economy. The strong response to Cohort 2 also reinforces the value of continued investment in the programme, enabling us to expand opportunities for young people, improve their livelihoods while strengthening the region's growing technology talent ecosystem.





They'd Never Written a Line of Code; Now They're HEAL-ing Communities Across Kenya

Anne Okingo had never written a line of code before joining Zone01 Kisumu. Neither had Andrew Osindo, Malika Asman, Kennedy Ada, or Hannah Apiko.

Six months later, after an intense period of learning Go, JavaScript, and Ruby through our tuition-free, peer-to-peer programme, these five apprentices came together to found **HEAL, a mental health care and support startup**. Drawing on their backgrounds in the medical field, Alice and Andrew led the team to winning the Code and Cheer Hackathon held at LakeHub Foundation in December 2024.

E4Impact, a social enterprise that supports the growth of impact-driven businesses across Africa, then selected HEAL for incubation, providing entrepreneurial training as the team continued their apprenticeship at Zone01 Kisumu.

Great innovations rarely go unnoticed. This quarter (Q1 2026), we are proud to share that **HEAL has been selected as a micro-grant recipient by the Wild Wonder Foundation for their HEAL in Nature project, one of only 12 initiatives chosen from 225 applications across 61 countries.**

With this grant, HEAL will pilot the HEAL-Impact initiative with 20 Community Health Volunteers trained in nature journaling, trauma-informed facilitation, and culturally sensitive group work. These volunteers will then reach approximately 400 survivors, introducing nature journaling as an accessible, sustainable, and culturally grounded tool for healing and emotional expression.

Across 10 months, 400 survivors, 20 volunteers, and 5 psychologists will explore how nature can become a healing partner, how creativity can help survivors process emotion safely, and how communities can build spaces where healing feels natural and dignified - an approach that ensures healing is locally owned, sustainable, and scalable in rural and low-resource settings.

None of HEAL's founding and growth would have been possible without your support over the past two years. This achievement shows what's possible when talented, driven young people are given the right environment to grow, and it is a testament to what strategic investment in youth at **Zone01 Kisumu** can unlock for communities in and around Western Kenya.

If you would like to support HEAL in their endeavour to create lasting change in local communities, please reach out to nyoirocaleb@zone01kisumu. Check out HEAL's website - https://healmentalcare.netlify.app/

250 SURVIVORS
reached through GBV psychosocial education sessions

15 WOMEN'S GROUPS
Impacted across Kisumu West so far





ZONE01 KISUMU DEPLOYS "CHICHWA" TO NORTHERN KENYA

At the close of 2025, nine Zone01 Kisumu apprentices were deep in the build phase of Chichwa, a digital marketplace designed to strengthen agricultural resilience and expand market access for smallholder farmers in Kenya's arid and semi-arid lands (ASALs), in partnership with the United Nations Development Programme.

Following needs assessment field visits to engage county officials, the National Drought Management Authority, Cooperatives, and farmers directly, the team designed a mobile-first solution accessible via USSD, SMS, and the web, built for the realities of low-connectivity, low-resource environments.

At the start of Q1 2026, UNDP extended the partnership, commissioning Zone01 Kisumu to deploy the marketplace and onboard key partners and users, a significant vote of confidence in both the platform and the apprentices who built it.

Led by Stacy Dina and John Odhiambo, the team currently is on the ground in Northern Kenya, working alongside UNDP, the governments of Turkana, West Pokot, Garissa, and Tana River Counties to build institutional capacity around the platform and gather feedback from the farmers and cooperatives it is designed to serve.

For the apprentices, Chichwa has proven to be a masterclass in building technology that works in the real world, navigating bureaucracy/engaging stakeholders, listening to end users, and iterating in the field - providing the kind of experience no classes can replicate.

We thank United Nations Development Programme for trusting our talent with the job of building a life-changing solutions for farmers in the Arid and Semi Arid Locations of Kenya.







THE BIGGEST TECH CONFERENCE IN WESTERN KENYA TO CELEBRATE THE SUCCESS OF ZONE01 KISUMU'S COHORT 1

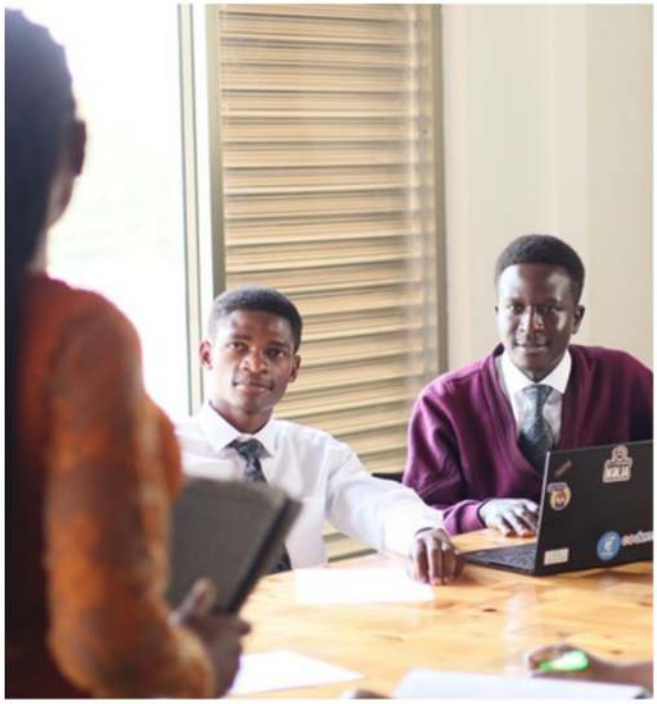
In April 2026, LakeHub and Zone01 Kisumu will host a first-of-its-kind tech conference bringing together developers, recruiters, founders, and ecosystem leaders.

The **Build From Here: From Learning to Shipping 2026** will also celebrate Zone01 Kisumu's first Cohort of trained software engineers who are transitioning from our peer-to-peer, tuition-free apprenticeship into real-world employment.

Jessica Colaco - Co-Founder iHub and Brave, **Ndiga Njeru** - Google Recruiter, **Wycliffe Aketch** - Venture Builder at BFA Global, **Eunice Allela** - Google Developer Relations Community Manager (SSA) and **Roina Ochieng** - Engineering Manager @OpenFn are some of the leading tech voices who'll grace the conference.

We'll platform our apprentices as they showcase their projects. We've also scheduled a speed recruiting session to help connect them to opportunities in the job. Both these activities will give employers direct access to emerging talent as well as enabling developers to demonstrate practical solutions they have built.

By convening talent, industry, and ecosystem partners in Kisumu, we've designed Build From Here Conference to bridge talent and opportunity as we highlight the growing potential of regional tech hubs strengthening pathways from training to meaningful employment in Africa's digital economy.



240 ATTENDEES
Registered for the Conference so far

12+ SPEAKERS
industry leaders with global experience

8 SESSIONS
targetted to transition apprentices to the job market



GIVE TO GAIN: IWD 2026

International Women's Day is a reminder of why women's voices matter. This year, under the theme "Give to Gain," we brought together women technologists, mentors, and developers for a workshop and panel discussion.

Activists and Women Empowerment champions Audrine Perpetua, Rozanne Achieng, our own Cohort 1 developer Alice Okingo, and Tech Mentor Bellah Oyucho shared their journeys with honesty and warmth.



Entrepreneurs Maxi Daniel and Winnie Odundo completed a day that celebrated mentorship, resilience, and the power of women lifting each other up.

But the most powerful story of the day belonged to Zone01 Kisumu's Hellen Onyango, 51, a trained nurse and master tailor who had spent years being turned away from every coding opportunity she found. Not once had she been priced out by Nairobi bootcamps, aged out of scholarship programmes, locked out by geography. She applied to Zone01 Kisumu three times before earning her place in Cohort 2.

> "I couldn't believe it when I walked in to Zone01 Kisumu, asked about the school fees and they told me the training is tuition-free. How?
>
> — ***Hellen Onyango, Cohort 2***

Today, Hellen is thriving. She hopes to build a digital-first fashion startup that combines her tailoring expertise with technology and to create pathways for others her age who were never given the chance she almost didn't get.

For us, Hellen is not an anomaly. She and every woman who spoke on that panel are living proof of our goal - to open doors that should never have been closed in the first place.



UNDP Visits LakeHub and Zone01 Kisumu

Grounded in our shared values and a commitment to transforming livelihoods, this collaboration continues to yield meaningful impact





This quarter, we hosted the United Nations Development Programme Disaster Risk Reduction and Recovery Team led by Ronald Jackson, Head of Disaster Risk Reduction, Recovery and Resilience Building. He was accompanied by Sophie Baranes, Rajeev Issar, Gatkuoth Kai, Paul Conrad, Evelyn Koech, Kimani Mutitu Raphael, and Michael Kibuku.

The delegation also included a technical team from the County Government of Kisumu, under the leadership of Deputy Governor Dr. Mathew Ochieng Owili.

During the visit, Zone01 Kisumu community members particularly, Women in Tech, demonstrated real-world solutions developed for social impact focused on climate and disaster resilience.

Hannah Juma and **Stacy Dina** presented the **Chichwa Market Platform**, which has been built to serve farmers and communities in Arid and Semi-Arid Lands.

Bellah Oyucho, a graduate of LakeHub's FemiDevs programme and now a Tech Mentor at Zone01 Kisumu, shared her journey in technology, illustrating the long-term impact of our training initiatives.

The visit and engagement reinforces our ongoing commitment to partnering with UNDP, Kisumu County, and Kenya's ASAL counties in building practical, community-driven technology solutions that address the pressing challenges of climate resilience and disaster risk reduction.

Q1 EVENTS AT ZONE01 KISUMU



Agentic AI Hackathon

In February 2026, we hosted our first hackathon of the year. Our apprentices came together for a 48-hour long hackathon challenge we called "The Agentic-AI Hackathon". Teams were tasked to build functional AI Agents that align with UN Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs).



System & Embedded Programming Conference

Conference introduced apprentices to the core concepts behind how software interacts with hardware, giving them a practical understanding of the technologies that power everyday devices. Through interactive discussions and demonstrations, attendees explored the basics of building efficient systems and developing solutions for real-world applications.



Local First Hackathon

This internal challenge tasked apprentices with building Progressive Web Apps (PWAs) or mobile-first systems capable of functioning in low-bandwidth conditions. The challenge was designed to push apprentices to think beyond ideal connectivity environments and develop solutions that reflect the realities of users in underserved and remote areas



LEAP Foundation Visit

We hosted Nigeria's LEAP Foundation at Zone01 Kisumu. LEAP Foundation is a youth-focused leadership development organization raising leaders who will transform Africa through interventions for young people, that bridges the gap in five areas: Education, Entrepreneurship, Employability, Active Citizenship and Health and Wellbeing

THE TEAM



Gender Balance

50/50

At the heart of LakeHub and Zone01 Kisumu is a team dedicated to empowering youth through transformative tech education. Our team is committed to building a future where opportunity is driven by skills, innovation, and collaboration. We foster a supportive, inclusive environment that nurtures talent and drives lasting social impact across Western Kenya and beyond.



Dorcas Owinoh
Co-Executive Director



Caleb Nyoiro
Co-Executive Director



Paul Oguda
Head of Tech



Lydiah Ojowi
Finance Manager



Torsten Kremser
Partnerships



Deril Ouko
Comms Lead



Bellah Oyucho
Tech Mentor



Stacy Dina
Tech Mentor



Alpha Omondi
Tech Mentor



Daisy Achieng
Comms Associate

STATEMENT OF EXPENDITURE

For the Quarter Ending 31st March 2026.

The Annual Budget for 2026 is **USD 474,269.92** and in this quarter, we have been able to raise **USD 275,618.75** towards the 2026 expenses

	Budget	YTD Actuals	Variance	Variance %
Revenue	**USD**	**USD**		
Grant Inflows		259,430.56		
Other earnings (Project Income)		21,195.96		
Total Revenue	**474,269.92**	280,626.52	-193,643.40	-41%

Expenses				
Program Expenses	287,142	63,412.44	-223,729.73	-78%
Operational Costs	187,128	48,900.12	-138,227.63	-74%
Total Expenses	**474,269.92**	**112,312.56**	**-361,957.36**	**-76%**



AI AND THE FUTURE OF SOFTWARE DEVELOPMENT: THREAT, TRANSFORMATION, OR EVOLUTION?

For decades, software engineers were kings. The undisputed architects shaping the digital age. However, as we navigate the early months of 2026, a new narrative has taken hold. News reports are full of screaming headlines declaring the imminent arrival of new AI-tools that will upend entire industries and processes. Indeed, and with agentic AI-models increasingly becoming capable of navigating million-line codebases and submitting their own pull requests, the prevailing question is:

Will AI replace software developers?

Employment data offers a nuanced answer. While job postings for software engineers rose 11% year-on-year in early 2026, the composition of those roles has shifted dramatically. A 13–20% decline in employment among early-career developers aged 22–25 reflects a sobering new reality, particularly in advanced economies. **Large technology companies are leveraging AI to extend the capacity of senior engineers, enabling one experienced developer to deliver what once required an entire junior team, a shift that, while on the surface appears efficient, carries its own risks.**

The picture looks markedly different in emerging markets. In less advanced economies, junior and intermediate developers with strong AI skills are rapidly increasing in value. **Non-tech industries are actively recruiting fresh talent versed in AI not just to strengthen their technology teams, but to embed intelligence across entire business processes**. This trend is reflected in the experiences of our own Zone 01 Kisumu developers, who report that their roles are expanding to include AI integration, deep debugging, and management of information security and ethics, areas where human judgement, contextual understanding, and accountability remain irreplaceable.

At the risk of blowing our own trumpet too loudly, Zone01 Kisumu anticipated this shift. As early as December 2024, we deliberately took steps to ensure our apprentices would be AI-ready by the time they entered the job market. That foresight has borne fruit. **As of Q1 2026, 70 out of 96 apprentices from Cohort 1 have been successfully placed in entry, intermediate and senior software development roles**. Building on that foundation, we hosted an Agentic AI Hackathon for our Cohort 2 apprentices, immersing them in the technologies reshaping the industry including building with autonomous agents, orchestrating AI-driven workflows, and critically evaluating AI-generated outputs in real time. **Undoubtedly, the future belongs to engineers who work alongside AI. At Zone01 Kisumu, we are making sure ours are ready.**



THANK YOU

To all our partners for trusting us with their tremendous and generous financial, in-kind donations, support, collaboration, and jobs that have helped us impact lives in 2026. Without you, every activity we have performed and achieved until now would not have been possible.

Funding Partners

PFE Partners for Equity

Livelihood Impact Fund

Segal Family Foundation

King Baudouin Foundation
Working together for a better society

Implementing Partners

Talent

UCLG Africa
CGLU Afrique

Hiring Partners

UNDP

Bongo Hub

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